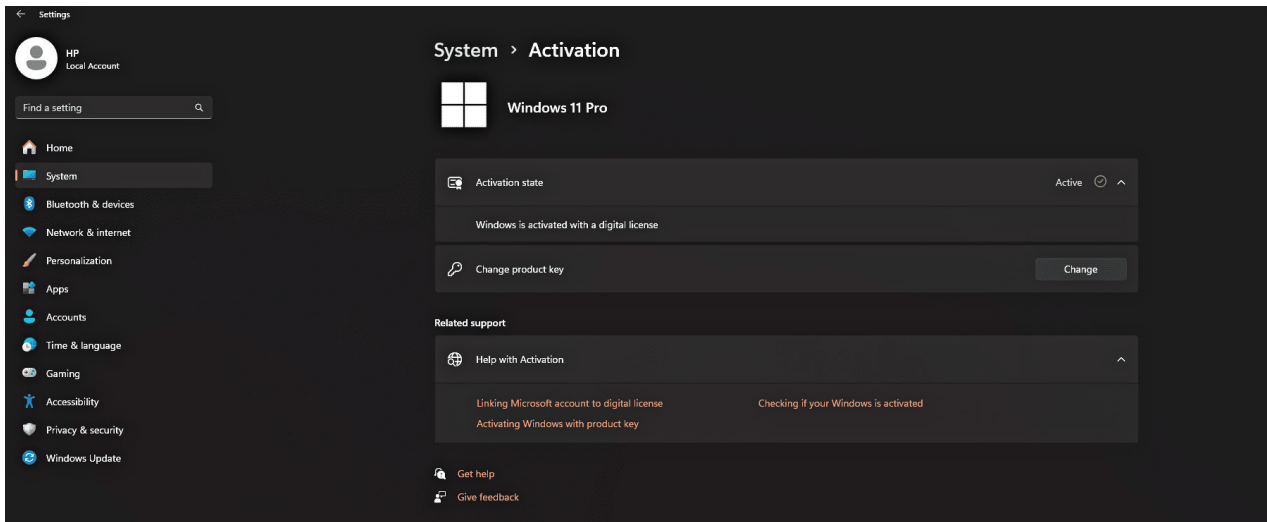




- nags you,
 - or duplicates Windows functions.
- Microsoft's official uninstall path is straightforward: Settings → Apps → Installed apps → Uninstall.

Step-by-step: Remove unwanted apps the safe way

1. Start → Settings
2. Go to Apps → Installed apps
3. Use the search box to find obvious candidates (examples):
 - trial antivirus you didn't subscribe to
 - vendor "assistant" apps you never open
 - shopping/entertainment apps you didn't install
4. Click the three dots (More) next to an app → Uninstall
5. Repeat slowly. Don't binge-uninstall like it's a Netflix series.

What NOT to uninstall (rule of thumb)

Be cautious with anything named like:

- Driver, Audio Console, Graphics Command Center, Chipset, Touchpad, Hotkeys, Firmware, BIOS update. These often support hardware-specific functions (brightness keys, trackpad gestures, audio tuning).

If you're unsure, leave it for now. We'll handle deeper cleaning later with a more detailed "what's safe" checklist.

7) A quick "bloat audit" in 10 minutes

Step-by-step: Check startup apps

1. Open Task Manager (Ctrl + Shift + Esc)
2. Go to Startup apps
3. Disable anything you:
 - don't recognise, or
 - don't need at boot

Examples of "usually safe to disable" for many users:

- Teams auto-start (if you don't use it daily)
- game launchers
- vendor store apps
- "updaters" for software you rarely use

Keep enabled: security tools you trust, touchpad/hotkey services, essential drivers.

Step-by-step: Check what's running in the background

1. Settings → Apps → Installed apps
 2. Click an app → look for Background app permissions (varies by app/build)
 3. Set unnecessary apps to Never
- This is where Windows 11 quietly wins: you don't have to "install an optimiser." You just stop unnecessary apps from behaving like they own your RAM.

8) Lock in the security basics

Windows 11's security posture relies on TPM + Secure Boot for features like identity protection and disk protection (Windows Hello / BitLocker/device encryption).

Step-by-step: Turn on the obvious protections

1. Open Windows Security
2. Check these sections:
 - Virus & threat protection: ensure real-time protection is on
 - Account protection: set up Windows Hello if available
 - Device security: check security processor / Secure Boot status

If you use your laptop for college projects, office documents, freelance client data, or anything sensitive, this is not optional. India has enough WhatsApp-forwarded scam links already – your OS doesn't need to be the weak link. **id**